



RCCG OCEANIA

Relationships

UNDERSTANDING LOVE IN MARRIAGE

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Marriage is a complex relationship that requires more than just physical attraction. Understanding the different kinds of love—Agape, Eros, and Filio—is essential for a lasting and fulfilling marriage. This study explores the importance of godly character and friendship in building a strong marital foundation.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

Romans 5:5

1 Corinthians 13:4-7

Ephesians 5:25-33

Song of Solomon 8:6-7

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Character is crucial in choosing a life partner.
- Attraction at first sight is not true love.
- Real love requires more than just feelings.
- Eros love is insufficient for a lasting marriage.
- Friendship plays a vital role in marriage.

INTRODUCTION

Marriage is a sacred union that thrives on more than just physical attraction. To build a lasting and fulfilling marriage, it is essential to understand the different kinds of love—Agape, Eros, Filio, and Storge—and their roles. This study delves into the importance of godly character and friendship as foundational elements in marriage.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **Romans 5:5** — Highlights the importance of God's love in our hearts.
- **1 Corinthians 13:4-7** — Defines the characteristics of true love.
- **Ephesians 5:25-33** — Describes the sacrificial love required in marriage.
- **Song of Solomon 8:6-7** — Illustrates the power and depth of love.

KEY POINTS

1. **CHARACTER MATTERS** — Character is a fundamental aspect when choosing a life partner. It is the essence of the person you will live with, beyond their outward appearance. A person's character reflects their values, integrity, and how they treat others. In marriage, character is what sustains the relationship through challenges and changes.

- Reflect on the character traits you value in a partner.
- Assess your own character and areas for growth.
- Discuss with your spouse how character influences your relationship.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 13:4-7

2. **BEYOND FIRST SIGHT** — Attraction at first sight is often mistaken for love. True love goes beyond initial attraction and involves deeper connections. It requires time to understand and appreciate the other person's inner qualities. This deeper connection is what sustains a relationship beyond the initial excitement.

- Consider the qualities that attracted you to your spouse beyond physical appearance.
- Spend time getting to know your spouse's inner qualities.
- Cultivate appreciation for your spouse's non-physical attributes.

Scripture: Song of Solomon 8:6-7

3. **THE NATURE OF REAL LOVE** — Real love is more than just a feeling; it involves commitment, understanding, and sacrifice. It is about choosing to love even when it is difficult. This kind of love is patient, kind, and selfless, as described in Scripture. It is the foundation for a strong and enduring marriage.

- Reflect on how you demonstrate commitment in your marriage.
- Identify ways to show understanding and sacrifice in your relationship.
- Pray for the strength to love selflessly.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 13:4-7 Ephesians 5:25-33

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

4. **LIMITATIONS OF EROS** — Eros, or passionate love, is important but not sufficient for a lasting marriage. It must be complemented by other forms of love, such as Agape and Filio. While Eros can ignite a relationship, it is the deeper, more enduring forms of love that sustain it.

- Discuss with your spouse the role of Eros in your marriage.
- Explore ways to cultivate Agape and Filio love.
- Balance passion with deeper emotional and spiritual connections.

Scripture: Ephesians 5:25-33

5. **FRIENDSHIP IN MARRIAGE** — Developing a strong friendship with your spouse is crucial for a healthy and enduring marriage. Friendship involves mutual respect, shared interests, and enjoying each other's company. It provides a solid foundation for navigating life's challenges together.

- Identify activities you enjoy doing together as friends.
- Strengthen your friendship by spending quality time together.
- Communicate openly and honestly to build trust.

Scripture: Song of Solomon 8:6-7

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What does Romans 5:5 say about the source of love?
- How does 1 Corinthians 13:4-7 describe love?
- What kind of love is highlighted in Ephesians 5:25-33?
- What imagery is used in Song of Solomon 8:6-7 to describe love?

INTERPRETATION

- Why is character important in choosing a life partner?
- How can initial attraction be misleading in understanding true love?
- What does it mean for love to be more than a feeling?
- Why is Eros love insufficient on its own for a lasting marriage?

APPLICATION

- How can you cultivate Agape love in your marriage?
- What steps can you take to deepen your friendship with your spouse?
- In what ways can you demonstrate sacrificial love in your relationship?
- How can understanding different kinds of love improve your marriage?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Pray for wisdom to understand and apply the different kinds of love in marriage.
- Ask for strength to cultivate Agape love and godly character in your relationship.
- Seek guidance to deepen friendship and mutual respect with your spouse.

NEXT STEP

Reflect on how you can incorporate the principles of Agape, Eros, and Filio love into your marriage to strengthen your relationship.

CONCLUSION

Understanding the different kinds of love—Agape, Eros, Filio, and Storge—is essential for a fulfilling and lasting marriage. By focusing on character, moving beyond initial attraction, and cultivating deep friendship, couples can build a strong foundation that withstands the tests of time. Let us strive to embody the love described in Scripture, ensuring our marriages reflect the love of God.